



Sundial

This carved rock is positioned at the very highest point in the city. It was used to track the movement of the sun. The sun aligned directly with the rock on the shortest day of the year, which meant it was time to celebrate the festival of Inti.

Roofs are made of thatch—plants and grasses that are woven together.

Observatory

At the crown of the city was a building that may have been an observatory. Priests would have come here to keep track of the sun's movements.

The high priests of the sun were often the emperor's brothers.

Priests and priestesses have a higher status than anyone except the emperor and his wives.

Nobles help the emperor run his empire, for example by collecting taxes.

These seams show where different pieces of the model were welded together.

Machu Picchu's buildings are linked by around 3,000 steps.



Gold of the gods

Gold was sacred to the Inca—it was known as the "sweat of the sun god." Gold was used to make decorative objects, particularly of gods. It was also used to make items to be offered to the gods, such as this golden llama.

"After seeing the ruins at **Machu Picchu**, the fabulous cultures of **antiquity** seemed to be made of cardboard, **papier-mâché** ..."

—Pablo Neruda, Chilean poet (1904-1973)